



APPS



Character.AI is adding a social feed to its app

characters

Given the fact that social media apps these days are [full](#) of AI-generated [videos](#), AI-native apps seem keen to cash in on the trend. The latest to jump on that bandwagon is Character.AI, which said on Monday that it is adding a social feed to its mobile apps that allow users to create AI characters and chat with them.

The social feed, which first came to the company's [web platform in June](#), lets users share images, videos, and their chatbots with other users. Users can also share snippets of their chats with characters, post AI-generated images based on their chats with a character, or even have their characters debate topics on a livestream.

The feed also lets you use the company's [generative video model, AvatarFX](#), to create video clips with text prompts and images, and share them on the feed.

“With our new Feed, the boundary between creator and consumer is disappearing. You can come to Feed for a lean-back experience and watch content from our amazing creators – but you can also take the story forward or create a new epic adventure,” said Karandeep Singh, Character.AI’s CEO, in a statement.

Character.AI isn’t the first company of its kind to dip its toes in the social media ocean: Video-generation app [Pika in July launched an invite-only](#)

TEC DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government’s website
- Instagram takes on Snapchat with new ‘Instagram Map’
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue’s AI-generated ad isn’t just about

[app](#) that lets users create and post videos using AI tools.

Topics: [AI content](#) [ai video](#) [Apps](#) [character.ai](#)

[Social](#) [social feed](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [reddit](#) [email](#) [link](#)



Ivan Mehta

[X](#) [in](#)

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING

fashion

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

APPS

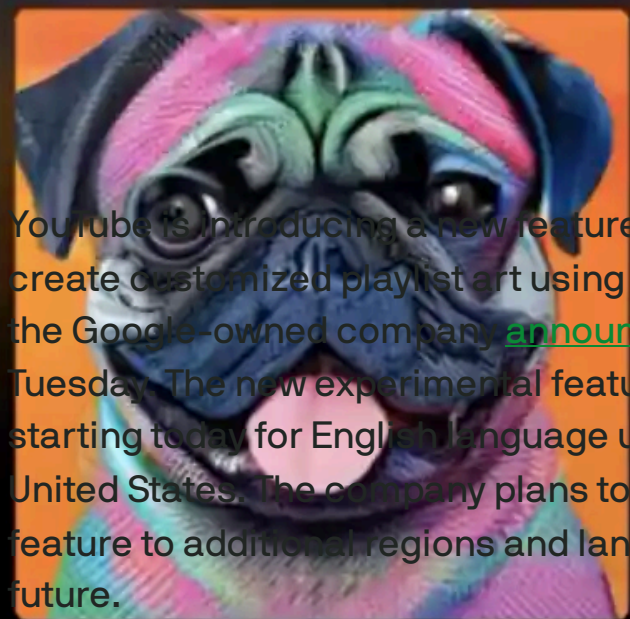
[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [reddit](#) [email](#) [link](#)

YouTube Music now lets you create custom AI-generated playlist art

Animals



Save



YouTube is introducing a new feature that lets users create customized playlist art using generative AI, the Google-owned company [announced](#) on Tuesday. The new experimental feature is rolling out starting today for English language users in the United States. The company plans to bring the feature to additional regions and languages in the future.

To get started, you have to click on the current default image of a playlist of yours. From there, you can scroll through a number of themes, such as travel, nature, landscape, fantasy, animals and humor. After you select a theme, you can scroll through a selection of prompts. For instance, if you select the animal theme, you can choose to receive an image of a pug “in the style of a Medieval Gothic painting” or “in the style of a Pop Art painting.”

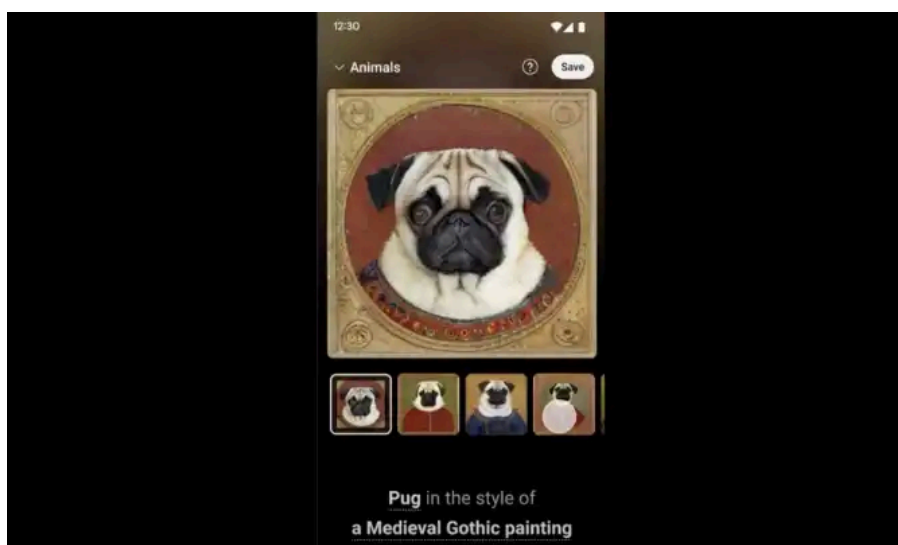


IMAGE CREDITS: YOUTUBE MUSIC

Once you have made your selections, you can click the “Create” button. You will then receive a series of AI-generated images that you can choose from.

Advertisement

Newsletters

[See More](#)

Subscribe for the industry’s biggest tech news

TechCrunch Daily News



Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch’s coverage.

Startups Weekly



Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

TechCrunch Week in Review



Get the best of our coverage, delivered to your inbox every Saturday.

TechCrunch Mobility



TechCrunch Mobility is your destination for transportation news and insight.

No newsletters selected.

After you have found one you like, you can click “save” to have it appear as your playlist art.

“The guided experience allows users to effortlessly explore from a range of visual themes and options to create one-of-a-kind cover art that expresses the uniqueness of your personal playlists,” the company wrote in a [blog post](#). “Struggling to find the perfect artwork for your 90’s R&B-inspired morning commute playlist? Don’t worry, we got you.”

YouTube Music also shared that in the coming months, it’s going to launch a new feature on the Home tab that makes it easier for users to quickly jump back in and listen to the songs and artists that they have had on repeat. Once users open up the app, they will see their recent favorites at the top of the Home tab. The feature will bring YouTube Music’s homepage somewhat in-line with Spotify’s, which lets users quickly jump back in and listen to their recent favorites. The company says the launch is part of its efforts to redesign parts of the YouTube Music app to help users easily find and play their favorite music.

The new features come as YouTube Music has been introducing new functionality to its service over the past few months. The service recently launched a TikTok-style [short-form personalized video feed](#) called “Samples.” Each clip in the feed offers a glimpse into the artist, music video and feel of a song recommended to you. YouTube Music also recently rolled out timed lyrics that let you follow the words on-screen as you listen, along with Comments, so users can express their thoughts in the app.

[YouTube Music is adding a TikTok-style ‘Samples’ short-form video feed](#)

Email address

Subscribe

By submitting your email, you agree to our [Terms](#) and [Privacy Notice](#).

Advertisement

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

Topics: [AI](#) [Apps](#) [Generative AI](#) [YouTube Music](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [e](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)



Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporter...

View Bio >

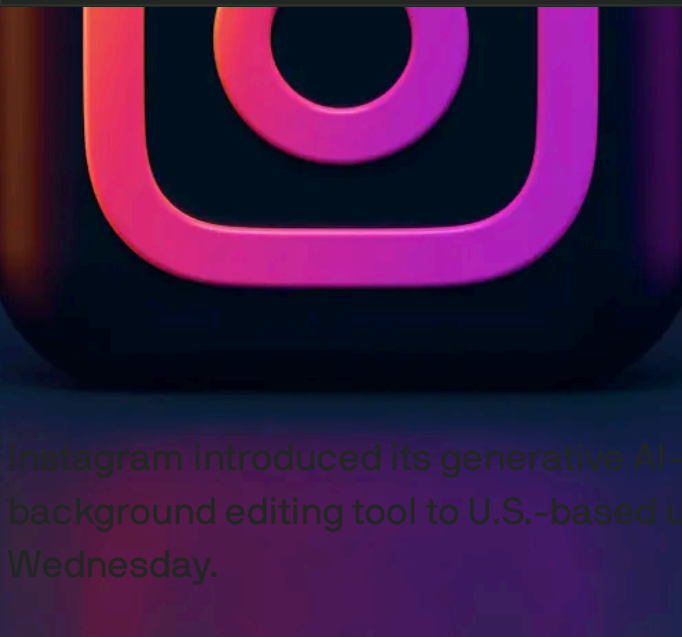
KEEP READING

Events

Podcasts

Newsletters

Ivan Mehta — 1:14 AM PST · December 14, 2023



Instagram introduced its generative AI-powered background editing tool to U.S.-based users Wednesday.

Meta's lead for generative AI, Ahmad Al-Dahle, [posted](#) on Threads saying that the tool will let users change the background to their images through prompts for Stories.

IMAGE CREDITS: [ALEXANDER SHATOV](#) / UNSPLASH

When users tap on the background editor icon on an image they will get ready prompts like “On a red carpet,” “Being chased by dinosaurs” and “Surrounded by puppies.” Users can write their own prompts to change the background as well.

Once a user posts a Story with the newly generated background, others will see a “Try it” sticker with the prompt so they can also play with the image generation tool.

Advertisement

Latest in Apps

See More

APPS



The Browser Company launches a \$20 monthly subscription for its AI-powered browser

Ivan Mehta - 8 hours ago



INSTAGRAM'S AI-POWERED BACKGROUND EDITOR IS AVAILABLE FOR U.S.-BASED USERS.

IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

Earlier this week, Snapchat released a new tool for its paying users that let them [create and send AI-generated images](#). In August, the company launched a new feature called Dreams, allowing [users to create fantastical images of themselves with different themes](#). Earlier this year, the social network rolled out the ability for Snapchat+ users to populate [prompt-based backgrounds](#).

Earlier in the month, Meta made its [28 AI-powered characters](#) available across all its apps — WhatsApp, Messenger and Instagram — for U.S.-based users, with support for Bing search and a better context window. At the same time, the company also launched [a standalone AI-image generator](#) called [Imagine with Meta](#), powered by its own model called [Emu](#).

Topics: [AI](#) [Apps](#) [Generative AI](#) [Instagram](#) [Meta](#)

[Social](#)

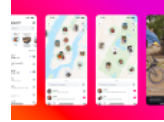
AI



Google takes on ChatGPT's Study Mode with new 'Guided Learning' tool in Gemini

Aisha Malik - 20 hours ago

APPS



Instagram takes on Snapchat with new 'Instagram Map'

Aisha Malik - 1 day ago

Advertisement

Advertisement



Ivan Mehta

X in

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING

APPS



What is Instagram's Threads app? All your questions answered

Twitter alternatives — new and old — have found audiences willing to try out a newer social networks since Elon Musk took over the company in 2022. [Mastodon](#), [Bluesky](#), [Spill](#) and [T2](#) are some of the social media platforms people are among them. So is Meta's Threads platform.

What is Threads? How do you create an account?

Threads is [Meta's text-based Twitter rival](#). It is tied to your Instagram account, so you can create an account by logging in using your Instagram credentials. [NATALIE CHRISTMAN, ALYSSA STRINGER](#) / SCREENSHOT

How is it different from Twitter?

Currently, there are no [paid tiers](#) and ads on the app. However, your verification mark from Instagram is carried over — even if you have paid for Meta Verified. Users can take advantage of their Instagram network to find people to follow.

The app launched more than a year ago, but it doesn't have Twitter-like features such as long video, direct messages, or live audio rooms.

How do you use Threads?

Advertisement

TC **DISRUPT**

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government's website
- Instagram takes on Snapchat with new 'Instagram Map'

The platform is currently available on iOS and Android in more than 100 countries. However, due to privacy concerns, the app was [not currently available in the EU](#) until [December 2023](#). At that time, Meta launched Threads in the region with an option for users to browse [the social network without an account](#) sans the ability to publish or interact with other posts.

Because you are logging in through your Instagram account, you will be able to follow all folks that you follow. You will also import your username, name, and settings, like block list.

How many users does this thing have?

As of November 2024, Threads [has more than 275 million monthly active users](#).

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

Advertisement

It's been a steady ramp-up. Within hours of launch, [Threads crossed the mark of 10 million sign-ups](#) and it reached 100 million users within just five days of launch.

What are the limitations of posting on Threads?

Users can post 500 characters in one post on the app. The post supports images, videos and GIFs. A Thread post supports up to 10 media items. As of July 17, Threads announced that it has to [tighten up on rate limits](#), or limits on how many posts users can view, due to spam attacks.

Can you use Threads on the web?

Yes, you can view posts and also publish from [Threads.net](#).

How do you delete your Threads account?

You can deactivate or delete your Threads account. Until the end of 2023, you had to [delete your Instagram account](#), according to Meta's ["Supplemental Privacy Policy"](#) to delete your Threads account. Meta keeps your data for 30 days after the initial deletion request. If you change your mind, you can cancel deletion within 30 days.

How can you customize your Threads experience?

Threads allows you to [pin search terms and tags as feeds](#). The company is also testing a way to create

custom feeds by adding [specific profiles and terms to a new feed](#). For the longest time, the social network’s own algorithmic “For You” feed was the default feed for users, but now [you can set any feed to default](#).

Meta’s newest social platform also got inspired by rival social network Bluesky and [made its own version of “Starter Packs”](#) — lists of people to follow based on different themes. In March, Meta announced that [Threads has started testing](#) a new feature that would allow people to add their interests to their profile, which would also direct users to active conversations about the topic.

Can you DM people on Threads?

You can’t send a message to users on the app. Instagram head Adam Mosseri said that the goal is to “not build yet another inbox and instead let people send threads to other apps.”

Does Threads have an API?

After testing the API with select partners for a few months, Threads finally launched [the public API in June 2024](#). Developers can build tools to publish posts of users and retrieve their own posts and gain insights about engagement. These tools can’t yet help you delete your posts.

Does that mean we will have third-party clients?

At this time, Threads’ API has limitations, like not allowing developers to fetch timeline data. So, it is not possible to create alternative clients for Threads at the moment.

Is Threads part of the fediverse?

Partially. Earlier in 2024, Threads started an experiment to let [users share their posts to the fediverse](#). So if users turn on fediverse sharing, people on other compatible ActivityPub networks like Mastodon can follow them and see their posts. Threads also allows users on the fediverse to like Threads posts.

In 2024, Meta extended fediverse support by adding a way for [Threads users to see replies from fediverse users on their posts](#), support for posts generated through [Threads API to be distributed on the fediverse](#), and also [check who is following them from other servers](#).

In December 2024, the company started allowing Threads users to follow profiles from [other fediverse servers](#).

What are some features that are currently missing from Threads?

- Full Fediverse integration
- Scheduling posts (coming soon)
- Direct messages
- Support for lists
- Support for third-party clients

What are Threads' data collection practices?

Because you are using an Instagram account to log in to Threads, Meta says that “it is part of your Instagram account.” Users have already [raised questions about the app’s data collection](#), given the privacy labels mentioned in the App Store.

In answer to queries about the app’s privacy labels on the App Store, Meta’s deputy chief privacy officer Rob Sherman said last year that these labels are similar to the company’s other apps.

“The labels are similar to the rest of our apps, including Instagram, in that our social apps receive whatever info (including the categories of data listed in the App Store) you share in the app,” he said in [a Threads post](#) at the time.

This story originally published July 6, 2023, and is updated regularly.

Topics: [Apps](#) [evergreens](#) [Instagram](#)

[Instagram Threads](#) [Meta](#) [Social](#) [Threads](#)

Advertisement

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [🌐](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)



Ivan Mehta

[X](#) [in](#)

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

View Bio >

Loading the next article



TechCrunch
Staff

Contact Us

Advertise

Crunchboard
Jobs

Site Map

Terms of
Service

Privacy
Policy

RSS Terms of
Use

OpenAI
Perplexity

Cisco
DeepMind

Windsurf
Tech Layoffs

ChatGPT